

Prompt Guide for Non-Developers

Project Narrative

While developing this guide, I focused on a problem that is the result of generative AI increasingly being integrated into the workplace: non-developers are increasingly expected to use generative AI tools, but lack clear, effective guidance on how to do so. My goal was to create a practical guide to code-free prompt engineering that helps technical writers, analysts, and other business users produce more accurate and useful AI-generated content.

I completed this project under tight constraints and because of this I had to be very intentional about scope and prioritize quality over completeness. Rather than attempting to cover more advanced prompt engineering concepts, I focused on delivering a concise, immediately actionable framework that users could apply without prior technical knowledge. I think the time constraints acted in my favor because I had to be laser-focused on my primary and secondary audiences.

My initial plan was to create a straightforward instructional document, but in execution, the project evolved into something more concise, structured, and user centered. I introduced the “GRASP IT” framework to provide a memorable, repeatable prompt-writing process, and focused on providing side-by-side prompt examples, a list of common mistakes, and a quick reference section. I also spent more time than expected refining examples to ensure they demonstrated not just what to do, but why the techniques described in the guide work.

One of my key “aha” moments was recognizing that it would not be useful to just explain prompt engineering concepts, I would need to add examples and provide a memorable framework to make them readily accessible in a fast-paced environment. For example, demonstrating how a vague prompt evolves through iteration proved far more effective than simply describing best practices. I also realized that audience definition is critical—not just as a constraint in the prompt itself, but as a guiding principle for the entire document. This influenced my decisions around tone, structure, and the level of detail.

If I were handing this off to another technical communicator, I would describe this project as an exercise in balancing scope, structure, and relevance under time constraints. My final deliverable reflects an intentional shift from explanations to practical tools and clear examples, with an emphasis on helping my audiences build a repeatable skill that is increasingly in demand in their workplaces.